

Rule 3.) Anything is essential if and only if it specifies exactly what it modifies is referring to.

NOTE Nonessential phrases must be surrounded by punctuation (typically commas)

Ex.

I remember the _____ when we met at the park.

- A. day,
- B. day
- C. day.
- D. day:

Ex. Which (always nonessential)

She finally finished the _____ which took longer than expected.

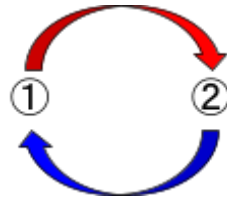
- A. project
- B. project;
- C. project,
- D. project:

Ex. That (always essential)

She finally finished the _____ that took longer than expected.

- E. project
- F. project;
- G. project,
- H. project:

Appositives also require essential/nonessential rules. An appositive is when idea ① is idea ② and idea ② is idea ①



Ex. Essential appositives

_____ taught us about mental disorders.

- A. Psychology professor, Jane Doe
- B. Psychology professor, Jane Doe,
- C. Psychology professor Jane Doe,
- D. Psychology professor Jane Doe

Ex. Nonessential appositives

My _____ taught us about mental disorders.

- A. psychology professor, Jane Doe
- B. psychology professor, Jane Doe,
- C. psychology professor Jane Doe,
- D. psychology professor Jane Doe

Ex.

At the zoo, we learned that _____ have mammary glands that secrete milk directly onto their skin.

- A. monotremes, an order of mammals including the platypus and echidnas
- B. monotremes an order of mammals including the platypus and echidnas,
- C. monotremes—an order of mammals including the platypus and echidnas—
- D. monotremes an order of mammals including the platypus and echidnas